MONTHLY UPDATE

Mauritius: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16-2 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.

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Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

MAURITIUS VISION 2050

- **Conseil des ministres | «Mauritius Vision 2050» : l'objectif d'une économie à USD 50 milliards d'ici 2050** — L'Express (Maurice), 11 September 2026

  Mauritius's Cabinet approved the final report of Mauritius Vision 2050 on 11 September 2026, aiming for an economy of about USD 50 billion (about Rs 2,300 billion) by 2050. It rests on prosperity, sustainability and inclusivity, and names digital among seven strategic sectors alongside financial services, tourism, logistics, the ocean economy, high-value agriculture and life sciences.

Legislation and regulation

ROAD TRAFFIC (AMENDMENT) BILL: DIGITAL DRIVING LICENCE AND ONLINE PENALTIES

- **«Road Traffic (Amendment) Bill» : Avinash Ramtohul : «Bâtir un avenir où les services publics suivent l'évolution technologique»** — L'Express (Maurice), 3 September 2026

Mauritius's ICT minister Avinash Ramtohul said on 3 September 2026 that the Road Traffic (Amendment) Bill gives the digital driving licence legal equivalence with the physical one and allows fixed penalties to be paid online or at any court. He said more than 800,000 licence holders are affected and that police will check licence data against a central database.

- **Paiement en ligne des amendes : le système bientôt mis en place** — Le Defi Media Group, 29 September 2026

  Mauritius's ICT minister Avinash Ramtohul said legal provisions allowing traffic fines to be paid online take effect on 30 October, covering only fines not linked to penalty points. The government is still finalising the system; fines can already be paid at any district court.

- **Permis de conduire numérique : une période de transition avant l'entrée en vigueur en 2027** — Le Defi Media Group, 29 September 2026

  Mauritius soft-launched a digital driving licence on the KOREK app for Android and iOS on 29 September 2026, with legal effect from 1 January 2027. From then, drivers stopped at the roadside must show the original or the digital licence; photocopies will not be accepted. Holders are asked to check their data and photo in the app and report errors.

- **Highlights of Cabinet Meeting - Friday 02 October 2026** — Prime Minister's Office, Mauritius, 2 October 2026

  Mauritius's Cabinet agreed on 2 October 2026 to regulations allowing traffic fines without penalty points to be paid online from 30 October, through the Supreme Court portal with MauPass login and MauCAS QR or card payment. It also noted a Meta visit on 6–7 October on platform representation, take-down requests and age assurance, and Statistics Mauritius's rebasing of GDP to 2023, which adds about Rs58 billion.

NATIONAL CRIME AGENCY BILL 2026

- **National Crime Agency Bill : ce que prévoit la future agence et jusqu'où iront ses pouvoirs** — Le Défi Media Group, 12 September 2026

  Mauritius published the National Crime Agency Bill 2026 on the National Assembly website, creating a lead agency to investigate financial crime, cybercrime and serious organised crime. It would repeal the Financial Crimes Commission Act 2023 and allow interception and real-time collection of communications data on a judge's order. The Assembly resumes on 20 October and the powers are not yet in force.

- **The National Crime Agency Bill (No. ..... of 2026) — bill text as published by the National Assembly of Mauritius** — National Assembly of Mauritius, 12 September 2026

  Mauritius's National Assembly published the National Crime Agency Bill around 12 September 2026, setting up a lead agency to investigate financial crime, cybercrime and serious organised crime. The bill creates divisions including a Cybercrime Division and a Digital Forensic Laboratory, and repeals the Financial Crimes Commission Act 2023. The bill text carries no date or number.

- **Délibérations du Conseil des Ministres du 11 septembre 2026** — Maurice Info, 13 September 2026

  Mauritius's Cabinet agreed on 11 September 2026 to introduce nine bills establishing a National Crime Agency as the lead investigator of financial crime, cybercrime and serious organised crime. The agency will gather and share intelligence and recover assets, and the Financial Crimes Commission Act will be repealed.

- **2 Senior Legal Experts Issue Warnings Over New Crime Agency Reform** — News Moris, 14 September 2026

Mauritius's Director of Public Prosecutions, Rashid Ahmine, welcomed most of the National Crime Agency Bill but warned the agency could remain a dead letter without government resources. Under the bill, intrusive surveillance needs a judge's authorisation. The Bar Association president, Antoine Domingue, noted the bill sets no terms of office or removal procedures for appointees.

- **National Crime Agency: How Independent Will It Really Be?** — Mauritius Times, 14 September 2026

  A Mauritius Times interview, published on 14 September 2026, examines the proposed National Crime Agency Bill. The commentator argues that constitutional status alone will not secure the agency's independence, and that appointment of its director-general by the President on the advice of a panel, after consulting the Prime Minister and opposition leader, leaves room for political influence.

ELECTRONIC TRANSFERABLE RECORDS UNDER THE BILLS OF EXCHANGE ACT

- **Africa's first electronic bill of exchange goes live under Mauritian law** — Trade Treasury Payments, 16 September 2026

  Mauritius Commercial Bank completed the first electronic bill of exchange under Mauritian law with Export Trading Group, which created five bills in under 30 minutes and transferred them to the bank in under an hour. It is the first live use of the electronic transferable records framework Mauritius adopted through the Finance Act 2025.

FRAMEWORK AGREEMENT WITH META ON ONLINE SAFETY

- **Highlights of Cabinet Meeting - Friday 02 October 2026** — Prime Minister's Office, Mauritius, 2 October 2026

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

- **Meta à Maurice : la sécurité en ligne au cœur des discussions** — L'Express (Maurice), 2 October 2026

  A Meta team is due in Mauritius on 6 and 7 October 2026 for meetings on moderating content in Mauritian Creole, child protection online, identity verification, faster takedowns and whether platforms should have a local presence. Mauritius' ICT ministry and Meta will also discuss a framework agreement on online safety.

- **Government engages Meta to curb online abuse for safer digital environment** — Ministry of Information Technology, Communication and Innovation (Mauritius), 8 October 2026

  Mauritius's ICT ministry met Meta on faster removal of fake accounts, impersonation and illegal content, moderation in Kreol and a local presence for the company. Amendments to the 2021 cybercrime law and age assurance for children were also discussed.

ELECTRONIC TRANSACTIONS (AMENDMENT) ACT 2026

- **From E-Signatures to AI-Driven Contracts: How Mauritius is rewriting the Rules of Digital Transactions** — Appleby, 5 October 2026

  Law firm Appleby reviews Mauritius's Electronic Transactions (Amendment) Act 2026. The Act accepts any reliable electronic signature that identifies the signer and shows intent, gives legal effect to electronic transferable records, and recognises contracts formed by automated systems without human review of each action. Under section 15A, where a certificate or signature originates does not by itself decide its effectiveness.

CYBERSECURITY, CYBERCRIME AND ICT ACT AMENDMENTS

- **Atelier Maurice-Meta : Vers une riposte plus rapide face aux dérives du numérique** — L'Express (Maurice), 8 October 2026

Mauritius's ICT ministry and Meta held a workshop at Ebene on 7 October 2026 on online abuse, disinformation and deepfakes. Figures presented show reported security incidents rising from 5,221 in 2024 to 6,073 in 2025 and cyberbullying cases from 491 to 702; the government is preparing bills and amendments to the ICT Act on cybersecurity and cybercrime, and wants faster takedown channels with Meta.

- **Avinash Ramtohul : «Il faut apporter un peu de discipline dans les réseaux sociaux»** — L'Express (Maurice), 10 October 2026

  Mauritius's ICT minister, Avinash Ramtohul, told L'Express on 10 October 2026 about a two-day working session with Meta on content moderation, reporting and takedown requests. He cited about 20 abuse cases reported a day, a takedown agreement involving the national computer emergency team CERT-MU and Meta verification of MPs' identities, and said Meta could open an office in Mauritius.

Data protection

COMMUNICATIONS INTERCEPTION

- **The National Crime Agency Bill (No. ..... of 2026) — bill text as published by the National Assembly of Mauritius** — National Assembly of Mauritius, 12 September 2026

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

Regional collaboration

INTERNATIONAL DECLARATION ON SPACE-BASED SCIENTIFIC DATA

- **International declaration on space-based scientific data.** — Élysée, 10 September 2026 ANGOLA DRC MADAGASCAR RWANDA TUNISIA GLOBAL

  Angola, the Democratic Republic of Congo, Madagascar, Mauritius, Rwanda and Tunisia are among the 49 states that signed, with the European Space Agency, a declaration on space-based scientific data published by France's presidency on 10 September 2026. It commits signatories to open access to satellite observation data, save for exceptions such as security and personal data, and to common exchange standards.

Standards

DIGITAL SERVICE FRAMEWORK

- **Digital Service Framework to strengthen Government digital services** — Government Information Service, Mauritius, 1 September 2026

  Mauritius will develop a Digital Service Framework setting mandatory principles and standards for every government digital service, from planning through operation, binding all services developed, procured or maintained by ministries. Cabinet noted it on 28 August; no compliance date is set.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

MOBILE NUMBER PORTABILITY

- **Portabilité mobile : Garder son numéro en changeant d'opérateur** — L'Express (Maurice), 8 October 2026

  Mauritius' ICT Authority opened a call for applications for a new mobile number portability licence, announced at a three-day ICTA workshop in Balaclava reported on 8 October 2026. Chairman Tassarajen Pillay Chedumbrum said subscribers will be able to keep their number and SIM when changing operator. No launch date is given.

Data Storage

CENTRAL BACKUP SERVICE

- **Computer Support (Central Backup Service)** — Central Information Systems Division (CISD), Ministry of Information Technology, Communication and Innovation, 1 September 2026

  Mauritius runs a central offsite backup service for government electronic media out of the central information systems division, alongside technical support and equipment commissioning for ministries and departments. It is the state's standing backup arrangement; the page publishes no capacity, retention period or restoration-test record.

Cybersecurity

REPORTED CYBER INCIDENTS

- **Atelier Maurice-Meta : Vers une riposte plus rapide face aux dérives du numérique** — L'Express (Maurice), 8 October 2026

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

DPI

Digital Identity and CRVS

DIGITAL DRIVING LICENCE ON THE KOREK APP

- **Permis de conduire numérique : une période de transition avant l'entrée en vigueur en 2027** — Le Defi Media Group, 29 September 2026

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

- **MauPass et KOREK! : les citoyens accompagnés dans leurs démarches** — Le Defi Media Group, 2 October 2026

  Mauritius Digital Promotion Agency staff will help citizens register on MauPass and reach their digital driving licence in the KOREK app from the coming week. The 883,700 licence holders have three months before the digital licence takes legal effect on 1 January 2027.

- **Permis de conduire numérique : Le compte à rebours est lancé** — L'Express (Maurice), 3 October 2026

  Mauritius's digital driving licence takes legal effect on 1 January 2027, after a transition period that began on 29 September. A driver may show either the digital licence on the KOREK app or the original physical licence, and the ICT minister said 500,000 people have registered on MauPass, the account needed to reach it.

Digital Payments and Fintech

COMESA REGIONAL PAYMENT AND SETTLEMENT SYSTEM (REPSS) SETTLEMENT BANK

- **Cross-border payments as a necessity for Africa's resilience and economic transformation** — Bank for International Settlements (central bankers' speeches); speech by the Bank of Mauritius, 13 October 2026

  SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

  The Governor of the Bank of Mauritius, Priscilla Muthoora Thakoor, told a Financial Stability Board workshop in Port Louis on 15 July 2026 that sub-Saharan Africa will miss the G20's 2027 targets for cross-border payments. She described REPSS, SADC-RTGS, TCIB and PAPSS as complementary regional systems and warned that stablecoins could undermine monetary sovereignty. The speech was posted on 13 October.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

ONLINE WASTE CARRIER LICENCE APPLICATIONS (ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT BOARD PLATFORM)

- **Ile Maurice: Les demandes de «Waste Carrier Licence» en ligne à partir d'octobre** — Le Mauricien (via allAfrica), 22 September 2026

  Mauritius's environment ministry announced on 21 September 2026 that applications for a Waste Carrier Licence must be made online through the Economic Development Board platform from October. The rule covers individuals, companies, parastatals, local authorities and ministries, who must upload scanned identity and vehicle documents.

ONLINE APPLICATION FOR THE STATE AGE PENSION

- **Highlights of Cabinet Meeting - Friday 09 October 2026** — Office of the Prime Minister, Mauritius, 9 October 2026

  Mauritius opened online applications for the State Age Pension from 7 October 2026, the Cabinet noted on 9 October, with a pension estimate app on the KOREK! government super-app. People with limited digital access can apply with help at 38 social security offices.

ONLINE APPLICATION PLATFORM FOR THE WATER TANK AND PUMP GRANT

- **«Water Tank and Water Pump Grant Scheme» : Les demandes d'aide pour les réservoirs d'eau bientôt en ligne** — L'Express (Maurice), 12 October 2026

  Mauritius's ICT ministry says it is building an online application platform with the Central Water Authority for a household water tank and pump grant announced on 9 October. Access terms are to follow.

Digitalisation

Rural digital data capture

DIGITAL LEARNING IN PRIMARY SCHOOLS

- **Virtual Reality in Primary Schools (VRPS)** — Mauritius Digital Promotion Agency, 1 September 2026

  Mauritius is putting immersive virtual reality into Grade 4 to 6 classrooms in state primary schools, across mathematics, science, history and geography and health and physical education. The digital promotion agency implements it for the technology ministry with the education ministry, the Rodrigues Regional Assembly and a university immersive media laboratory. No school count or pupil reach is published.

RURAL DIGITAL DATA CAPTURE

- **Virtual Reality in Primary Schools (VRPS)** — Mauritius Digital Promotion Agency, 1 September 2026

  Summarised under Rural digital data capture.

Technology

AI

AI CITY SCHEME

- **Convention internationale GOPIO : Dhaneshwar Damry annonce la création d'une «AI City»** — L'express (Maurice), 13 September 2026

> Mauritius' junior finance minister Dhaneshwar Damry told the 16th GOPIO international convention in Balaclava that the government will set up an "AI City" within the next two to three months. He presented Mauritius as an investment gateway and risk-reduction centre for Africa. No cost, location or operator is given.

ICT Industry

> DEVELOPMENT-FUND STAKE IN A DOMESTIC DIGITAL SERVICES FIRM

- **Le fonds AfricInvest investit dans la société mauricienne Spoon Consulting** — wearetech.africa, 7 September 2026

  A pan-African investment fund took a minority stake in a Mauritian digital transformation firm, with no sum disclosed.

Data

National statistics

> CENTRAL BANK CENTRAL STATISTICAL DATABASE

- **PM unveils BOMStats, a new gateway to trusted, timely economic and financial data** — Government Information Service, Mauritius, 3 September 2026

  Mauritius's prime minister, Navinchandra Ramgoolam, launched BOMStats, the Bank of Mauritius's central statistical database, in Port-Louis on 3 September 2026, the bank's 59th anniversary. It was developed with the IMF and the African Development Bank. Ramgoolam said the Statistics Act and the Bank of Mauritius Act are being reviewed after an IMF assessment of data standards.

Open data

> CENTRAL BANK STATISTICAL DATA PLATFORM

- **Bank of Mauritius expands access to official statistics with rollout of BOMStats platform** — Bank of Mauritius, 3 September 2026

  The Bank of Mauritius launched BOMStats, its statistical data platform, on 3 September 2026, with Prime Minister Navinchandra Ramgoolam presiding. The platform offers self-service analytics, an API and SDMX-format data sharing, and the bank says it is the first African central bank to use Open Data Platform 2.0. It was built with support from the African Development Bank and the IMF's Statistics Department.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

> AMAZON WEB SERVICES MEMORANDUM

- **Cloud, données et IA : Mauritius Telecom et AWS mobilisent les entreprises publiques** — L'Express (Maurice), 7 October 2026

  Mauritius Telecom and Amazon Web Services brought more than 125 delegates from state-owned enterprises to an executive workshop on cloud, data and AI at Ebene on 6 October, to identify uses in public services.

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